- **2000 onwards:** The growth and globalization drive of the Tata Group gathers pace under his stewardship and the new millennium sees a string of high-profile Tata acquisitions, among them Tetley, Corus, Jaguar Land Rover, General Chemical Industrial Products and Daewoo.
- **2008:** Unveils the Tata Nano, born of the trailblazing small-car project he guided and commanded with zeal and determination.
- **2008:** Awarded the Padma Vibhushan, the country's second-highest civilian honour, by the Government of India.
- **2012:** Steps down as chairman of Tata Sons after fifty years with the Tata Group; is appointed Chairman Emeritus of Tata Sons.
- **2016:** Returns briefly as the interim chairman, replacing Cyrus Mistry, who was his successor.
- **2017:** Steps down again and retires; is appointed head of the Tata Trusts. N. Chandrasekaran is appointed chairman of Tata Sons.
- **2021:** Tata Sons wins a bid to acquire Air India, bringing it back to the group after nearly seven decades.
- **2022:** Opens seven state-of-the-art cancer centres in Assam as part of his philanthropic initiatives.